

IDEAS

01

Stacked Bar Chart

02

Grouped Bar Chart

03

Connected Dot Plot

04

Violin + Box Plot

05

Scatter + Trend Line

06

Lollipop Chart

07

Slope Chart

08

Diverging Bar Chart

09

Heatmap

10

Matrix / Table

11

Small Multiples

12

Ranked Dot Plot

13

Scroll Narrative

14

Tab Dashboard

15

Stepper Layout

16

Bump Chart

17

Static Log Page

18

Dropdown Filter

19

Range Slider

20

Tooltip

21

Radio Button

22

Toggle

23

Linked Highlight

24

Headline Numbers

25

Question Decomp.

26

Data Coverage Gap Callout

FILTER

#9 → Heatmap: poor at differentiating small % change across cells.

#10 → White-cell table: individual unit encoding becomes unreadable.

#2 → Toggle: interaction complexity without clear payoff.

#17 → Static log page: needs interactivity to be meaningful.

#6 → Lollipop: redundant with bar + dot plot combination.

#8 → Diverging bar: realistic neutral midpoint may not exist in this data.

#13 → Scroll narrative: JavaScript dependency — excluded per course constraints.

#23 → Linked highlight: patterns matter more than individual row comparison.

CATEGORISE

Ideas that Set Context

#24, #25, #12

Orients the reader before analysis. Establishes scale, frames questions, shows what is most prominent.

Ideas that Frame the Narrative

#25, #26

Tells the reader what data can and cannot show. #26 serves double duty — contextualises entry point and frames the whole narrative.

Ideas that Show Comparisons

#1, #2, #3, #5

Lets the reader see differences between groups or across an ordered axis.

Ideas that Show Distribution & Variability

#4, #6

Reveals spread and shape behind summary stats. #11 can serve as companion across subgroups and as a layout device.

Ideas that Give Reader Control

#18, #19, #20, #21

Interactive controls. Augment charts, not standalone. Risk: complexity without payoff for a policymaker audience.

COMBINE & REFINE

Design A — Sequential Stepper

Fully author-driven. Fixed path Q1→Q2→Q3. Each step: one chart + narrative text panel alongside.

Design B — Dashboard

Fully reader-driven. All panels visible at once. Dropdown + slider for filtering.

Design C — Tabbed Layout

Reader-driven via tabs. One tab per research question. Dropdown filters within each tab.

QUESTIONS

Q1

Does any design give a policymaker a clear sense of what action to take?

Design A ends at a clear policy implication. B and C leave the reader to draw their own conclusions, risking unresolved questions for a non-expert audience.

Q2

How much narrative text does a policymaker need alongside each chart?

Design A allocates explicit text panels per chart. B and C prioritise chart real estate over narration — risky for a policymaker who needs framing to act.

Q3

If a reader enters mid-way, can they understand without reading earlier sections?

Design B handles this best — each panel is self-contained. Design A breaks without sequential reading. C partially handles it via tab labels.

Q4

Does Design A's fixed sequence risk losing a reader interested in only one question?

Yes, but acceptable — policymakers need the full picture to act. Author-controlled narrative is appropriate for this audience.

Q5

Does Design B's simultaneous visibility create cognitive overload?

Yes. Showing all three questions at once without a guided entry overwhelms a non-expert reader. Works for analysts, not policymakers.

Q6

Does Design C's tab structure communicate a single connected argument?

Not clearly. Tabs imply independent content. A reader can close after one tab and miss the full argument. Linking narrative between tabs is needed.

Q7

How do we communicate the structural data gaps without it looking like incomplete analysis?

Frame the 29-LGA coverage gap as a policy-relevant finding: VISTA does not survey regional Victoria, meaning policymakers currently lack travel behaviour evidence to evaluate investment in those areas. Present as a prominent callout, not a limitation footnote — the gap itself is part of the story.